

IAS PRELIMS/MAINS

Ecology & Environment

A stylized illustration of a green city skyline with various skyscrapers, wind turbines, and a sun, set against a light green background with a globe-like shape.

A COMPREHENSIVE COVERAGE

MODULE - 10

WETLANDS - 3

MEASURES TO PROTECT WETLANDS

- International treaty for “the conservation and sustainable use of wetlands”.
- The Convention was signed on 2nd of February, 1971, So 2nd of February each year is celebrated as World Wetlands Day.
- At the center of the Ramsar philosophy is the “wise use” of wetlands. India is a party to Ramsar Convention.



THE WISE USE CONCEPT

- The Ramsar philosophy is the 'wise use' concept. The wise use of wetlands is defined as 'the maintenance of their ecological character, achieved through understanding and creating awareness about the various ecological services provided by Wetlands, and by emphasizing on the concept of sustainable development.'
- Wise use therefore means the conservation and sustainable use of wetlands and their resources, for the benefit of humankind.

NEED FOR SUCH CONVENTION

- Wetlands provide us countless benefits, ranging from
 - ✓ freshwater supply,
 - ✓ biodiversity,
 - ✓ flood control,
 - ✓ groundwater recharge, and
 - ✓ climate change mitigation.
- But sadly 64% of the world's wetlands have disappeared in the last century which necessitated the formation of such convention.

The Convention uses a broad definition of wetlands.

RAMSAR DEFINITION OF WETLANDS

- Wetlands are areas of marsh, peatland or water whether natural or artificial, permanent or temporary with water that is static or flowing, fresh, brackish or salt, including areas of marine water the depth of which at low tide does not exceed 6 meters.
- So, the definition includes all lakes and rivers, underground aquifers, swamps and marshes, wet grasslands, peatland, oases, estuaries, deltas, mangroves and all human-made sites such as fish ponds and reservoirs.

NEED FOR SUCH CONVENTION

Under the Convention, the Contracting Parties commit to:

- Work towards the wise use of all their wetlands;
- Designate suitable wetlands to be included in the List of Wetlands of International Importance (the “Ramsar List”) and ensure their effective management;
- Cooperate internationally on trans-boundary wetlands.

The inclusion of a wetland in Ramsar List embodies the government’s commitment to take the steps necessary to ensure that its ecological character is maintained.

THE MONTREUX RECORD

- The Montreux Record is a register of wetlands included in the Ramsar List where changes in ecological character have occurred, are occurring, or are likely to occur.
- It is maintained as part of the Ramsar List.

Montreux Sites in India:

- The present Ramsar sites of India in Montreux Record are:
 - ✓ Keoladeo National park, Rajasthan.
 - ✓ Loktak lake, Manipur

Chilka lake of Odisha was previously in Montreux Record but was removed due to successful conservation efforts.



KEOLADEO NATIONAL PARK, RAJASTHAN



LOKTAK LAKE, MANIPUR



INDIA

BANGLADESH

JHARKHAND

WEST BENGAL

CHHATTISGARH

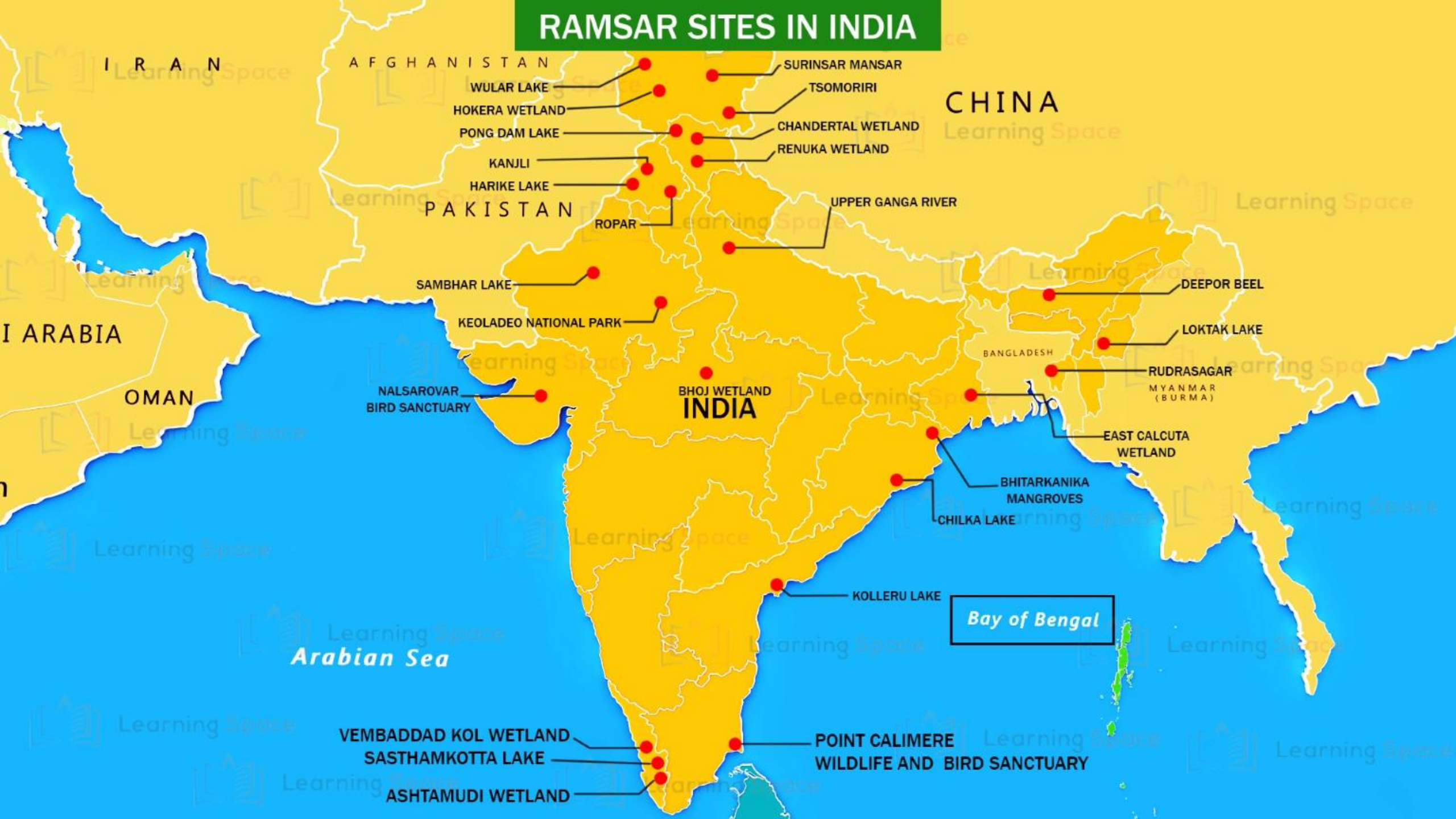
ODISHA

Chilika Lake

Bay of Bengal

ANDHRA PRADESH

RAMSAR SITES IN INDIA



CHINA

PAKISTAN

INDIA

BANGLADESH

MYANMAR
(BURMA)

Bay of Bengal

Arabian Sea

WULAR LAKE

HOKERA WETLAND

PONG DAM LAKE

KANJLI

HARIKE LAKE

SURINSAR MANSAR

TSOMORIRI

CHANDERTAL WETLAND

RENUKA WETLAND

UPPER GANGA RIVER

ROPAR

SAMBHAR LAKE

KEOLADEO NATIONAL PARK

NALSAROVAR
BIRD SANCTUARY

BHOJ WETLAND

DEEPOP BEEL

LOKTAK LAKE

RUDRASAGAR

MYANMAR
(BURMA)

EAST CALCUTA
WETLAND

BHITARKANIKA
MANGROVES

CHILKA LAKE

KOLLERU LAKE

VEMBADDAD KOL WETLAND

SASTHAMKOTTA LAKE

ASHTAMUDI WETLAND

POINT CALIMERE

WILDLIFE AND BIRD SANCTUARY

WE EXPRESS OUR
SINCERE THANKS
FOR VIEWING THIS VIDEO

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